

Web Development Specialist

Practical Assessment

Suggested time: 90 minutes **Deadline:** 5 days from receipt **Return format:** A ZIP file or a link to a GitHub repo

Before you start

Four tasks. Read all of them first. You do not need to be perfect on every one. We would rather see strong work on the parts you know well and an honest note on the rest than padded answers across the board.

Please also send: links to two or three sites you have built or worked on, with a line each on what you were responsible for. If the work is under NDA or has since been redesigned, tell us and describe it instead.

On AI tools: you are welcome to use them. We use them too. Just tell us where, in the short declaration at the end. Using AI well is a skill. Passing off output you do not understand is not, and it will show in the follow-up conversation.

Include a short README covering how to view your work, any assumptions you made, and anything you would do differently with more time.

Task 1: Front-end build

30 points

Build a responsive **pricing section** as a self-contained HTML/CSS/JS component.

- Three tiers, with the middle one visually marked as recommended
- A monthly / annual toggle that updates prices without a page reload (annual is 20% cheaper)
- Three columns on desktop, stacked on mobile
- Semantic HTML, keyboard accessible
- No CSS framework, no jQuery. Vanilla only

Visual treatment is up to you. We are looking at how you structure code and how much care goes into spacing, hierarchy and states, not whether you match a mockup. It does not need to be pixel-perfect to count.

Task 2: Code review

30 points

Part A: WordPress

This shortcode made it onto a live client site.

```
function get_featured_posts() {
    global $wpdb;
    $cat = $_GET['cat'];
    $results = $wpdb->get_results(
        "SELECT * FROM wp_posts
        WHERE post_status = 'publish'
        AND ID IN (
            SELECT object_id FROM wp_term_relationships
            WHERE term_taxonomy_id = $cat
        )"
    );
    foreach ($results as $post) {
        echo '<div class="post"><h3>' . $post->post_title . '</h3>';
        echo '<p>' . $post->post_content . '</p></div>';
    }
}
add_shortcode('featured', 'get_featured_posts');
```

A1. List the problems you can find, with the actual risk or consequence of each. **A2.** Rewrite it properly.

Part B: Front-end

```
<head>
<title>Home</title>
<script src="https://code.jquery.com/jquery-3.6.0.min.js"></script>
<script src="/js/slider.js"></script>
<link rel="stylesheet" href="/css/main.css">
</head>
<body>
```

```
<div class="header">
  <div class="logo"></div>
  <div class="nav">
    <div onclick="location.href='/services'">Services</div>
    <div onclick="location.href='/about'">About</div>
  </div>
</div>
<div class="hero">
  <h2>Welcome to our website</h2>
  
  <div class="btn" onclick="location.href='/contact'">Get in touch</div>
</div>
</body>
```

B1. Bullet the issues across accessibility, SEO and performance, with the fix for each. No need to rewrite the whole thing.

Task 3: API integration

20 points

A client wants live currency conversion on their product pages. Prices are stored in GBP. Visitors should see their local currency, with GBP still shown underneath.

Using any free public exchange rate API (say which one you chose):

3a. Write the code that fetches rates and updates prices on the page. **3b.** Briefly: how did you handle failure, caching and the exposed API key? What does the user see when the call fails?

3c. In a few sentences: if this were a real Shopify build, where would this logic actually live, and why?

Task 4: Judgement and communication

20 points

4a. A client wants a 40-page brochure site with a blog, a filterable team directory, and a tagged case study library. No in-house technical staff, and they want to edit content themselves. Which platform do you recommend, and what would you push back on? Three or four sentences.

4b. You inherit a WordPress site running 43 plugins, no staging environment, and no version control. What are your first three actions, in order?

4c. A client's e-commerce site went down for two hours yesterday morning. A plugin auto-update conflicted with the theme. It is fixed, auto-updates are now off, and a staging environment is being set up. Write the email you would send them. They are not technical and they are annoyed.

Declaration

- Approximate time spent:
 - AI tools used, and on which tasks:
 - What you changed or rejected from the AI output:
 - Anything you could not complete, and why:
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Thank you for taking the time. We read every submission properly, and you will hear back from us if successful.